

Proposal for Emoji: Stomach

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Identification

Suggested name: Stomach

Suggested keywords: digestion; gut; belly; abdomen; hunger; appetite; fullness; nausea; indigestion; reflux

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The paradigm is a bold asymmetric J-shaped stomach with a long inlet, deep open inner concavity, broad lower body, and distinct short outlet. These cues separate it from food, beans, a generic blob, and other solid organs. Vendors may vary angle, color, outline, and shading while preserving the inlet, open concavity, and outlet at typical emoji sizes.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Stomach has established anatomical, emotional, and figurative meanings. It can refer to the digestive organ, hunger or fullness, a nervous stomach, butterflies in the stomach, tolerance expressed through a strong stomach, and the ability to accept something unpleasant. These meanings support ordinary communication about food, sensation, emotion, and tolerance without depending on a newly invented pun.

Cambridge Dictionary documents both the expression butterflies in your stomach and the verb sense of stomach, meaning to accept or deal with something unpleasant:

<https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/butterflies-in-stomach>

<https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/stomach>

B. Use in sequences

Stomach adds a specific organ meaning to several short combinations:

- Stomach + fork and knife: hunger, a meal's effect, fullness, or digestion.
- Stomach + nauseated face: an upset stomach, nausea, or a stomach bug.
- Stomach + butterfly: nervous anticipation or butterflies in the stomach.
- Stomach + pill or hospital: antacid use, digestive treatment, or stomach-specific care.

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. Nauseated Face expresses a symptom, and food emoji represent what is eaten. Neither identifies the stomach itself. No current emoji or short sequence directly represents the stomach as an organ and broad semantic building block. Stomach therefore adds a distinct concept for digestion, hunger, fullness, physical sensation, figurative expression, education, and health.

D. Distinctiveness

The selected image uses an asymmetric J shape, long inlet, deep inner concavity, broad lower body, and separate outlet. Its identity rests on silhouette rather than color or fine internal texture. The open concavity and two connected passages distinguish it from Anatomical Heart, Beans, Meat on Bone, Kidney, Liver, and a generic organ shape.

Deterministic validation checked exact dimensions, true black-and-white palette, foreground connectedness, and normalized 18x18 silhouette separation against those six declared confusers using pinned assets. Both 18x18 Stomach assets passed: the maximum normalized silhouette intersection-over-union was 0.638 against a 0.72 ceiling, and the minimum 64-bit difference-hash distance was 19 against a 16 floor. These checks establish machine-visible separation; they do not substitute for human semantic recognition.

E. Expected usage level

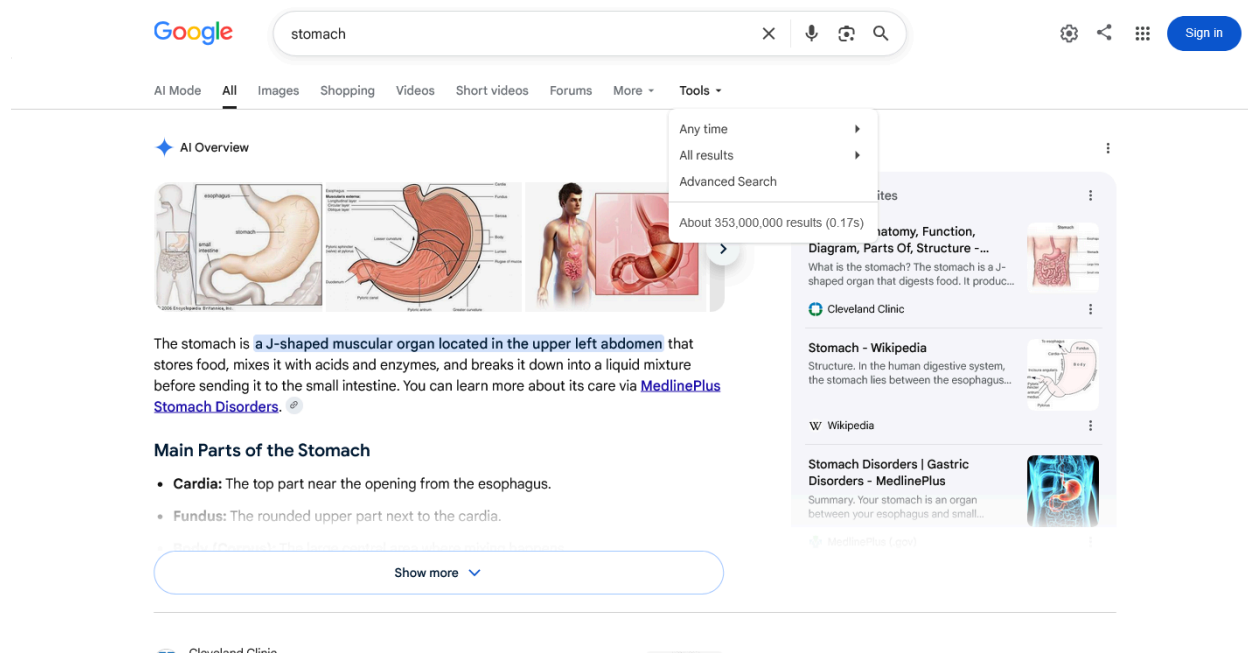
Stomach is an ordinary term used in communication about digestion, eating, hunger, appetite, fullness, nausea, stomach aches, indigestion, reflux, medication, education, and figurative emotion. The National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases describes the stomach's central role in receiving food, mixing it with digestive juices, and emptying its contents into the small intestine:

<https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/digestive-diseases/digestive-system-how-it-works>

The five frequency sources below measure public use from complementary perspectives. Google Trends and Google Books compare `stomach` with Unicode's reference term `elephant`.

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26. The page displays an estimated 353,000,000 results. This volatile estimate is presented only as the result-count measure requested by the proposal guidelines, not as a count of users or intended emoji uses. Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?q=stomach&hl=en&filter=0>



Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-26. The page displays an estimated 139,000,000 video results. This volatile estimate is not a count of users or intended emoji uses. Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=stomach&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>



stomach





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www.youtube.com › watch

Anatomy and Physiology of the Stomach, Animation



5:19

A&P of the Gastrointestinal System - **Stomach** wall layers, **stomach**, Secretory cell types (mucous, parietal, chief, ...)

YouTube · Ailla Medical Media · Apr 24, 2023

10 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch

Stomach: Histology



8:00

What is the **stomach**? The **stomach** is an expanded portion of the gastrointestinal tract or GI tract that partially digests food by breaking it ...

YouTube · Osmosis from Elsevier · Dec 17, 2024

9 key moments in this video

www.osmosis.org › video › Stomach_histology

Video: Stomach histology



8:04

Mucous cells secrete mucus, which protects the **stomach** lining from the acidic environment of the **stomach**. The muscularis layer is responsible for ...

Osmosis · Jul 31, 2024

www.khanacademy.org › science › gastrointestinal-intro

Stomach (video) | Components of the GI tract



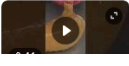
5:58

This process involves receiving a bolus of food, churning it, and breaking it down through hydrolysis, resulting in a product called chyme. The...

Khan Academy · Oct 6, 2015

www.youtube.com › shorts

How Big is the Human Stomach?



0:15

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YouTube · Institute of Human Anatomy · Apr 25, 2024

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Advanced Search

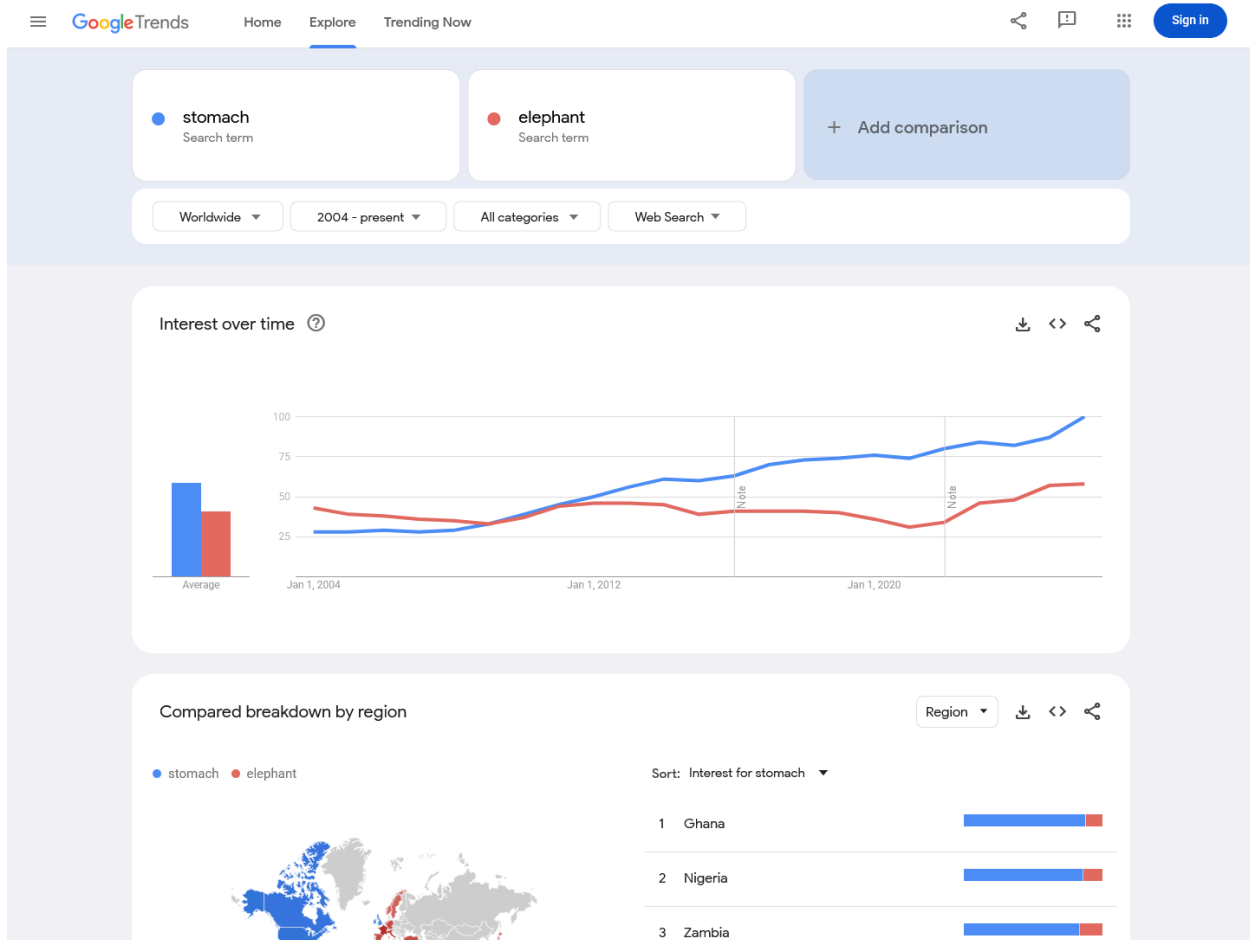
About 139,000,000 results (0.16s)

4 of 8

Google Trends - Web Search

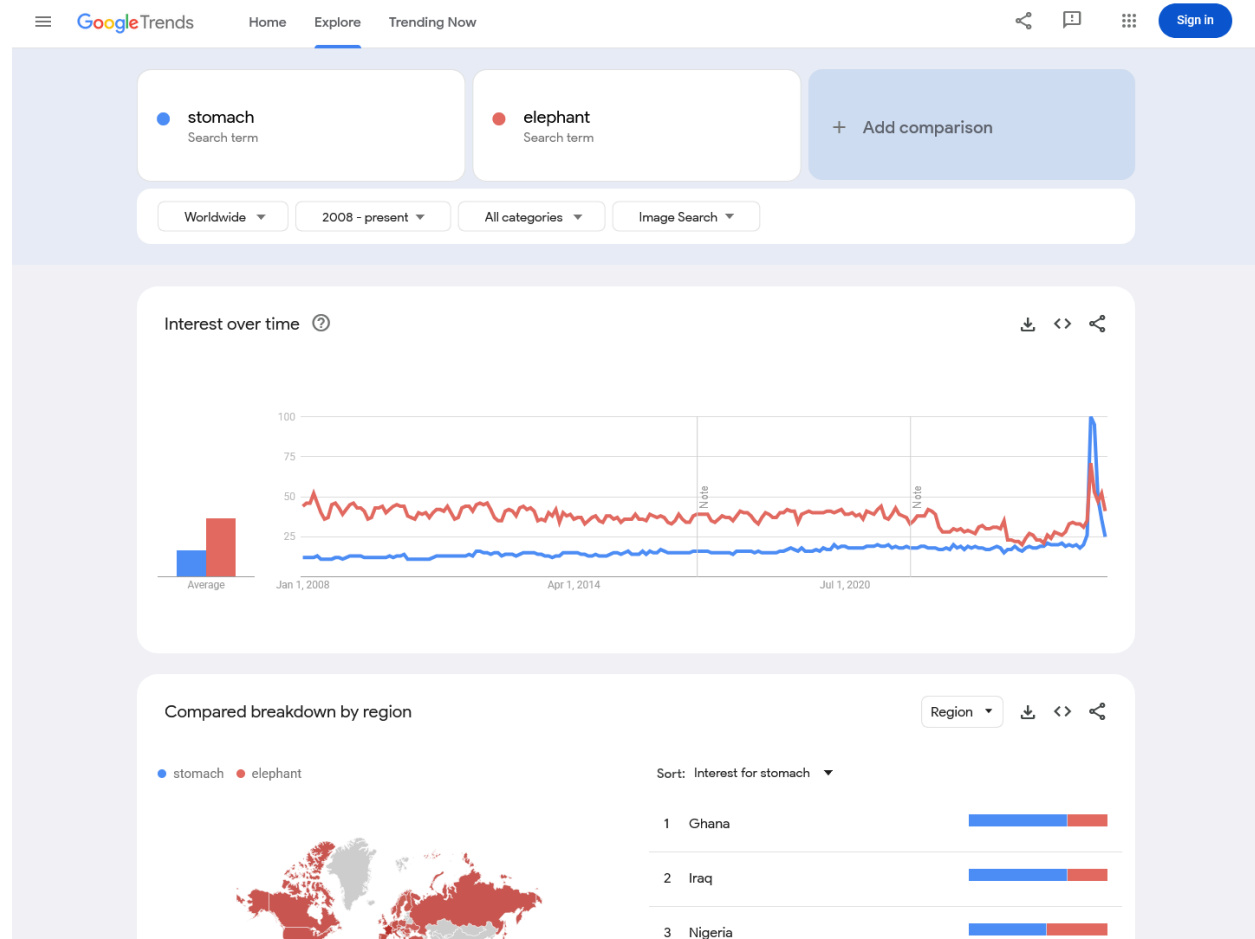
Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories, and Web Search. Stomach has the higher displayed average across the full range and a strong sustained lead in recent years.

Reproducible query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=stomach,elephant>



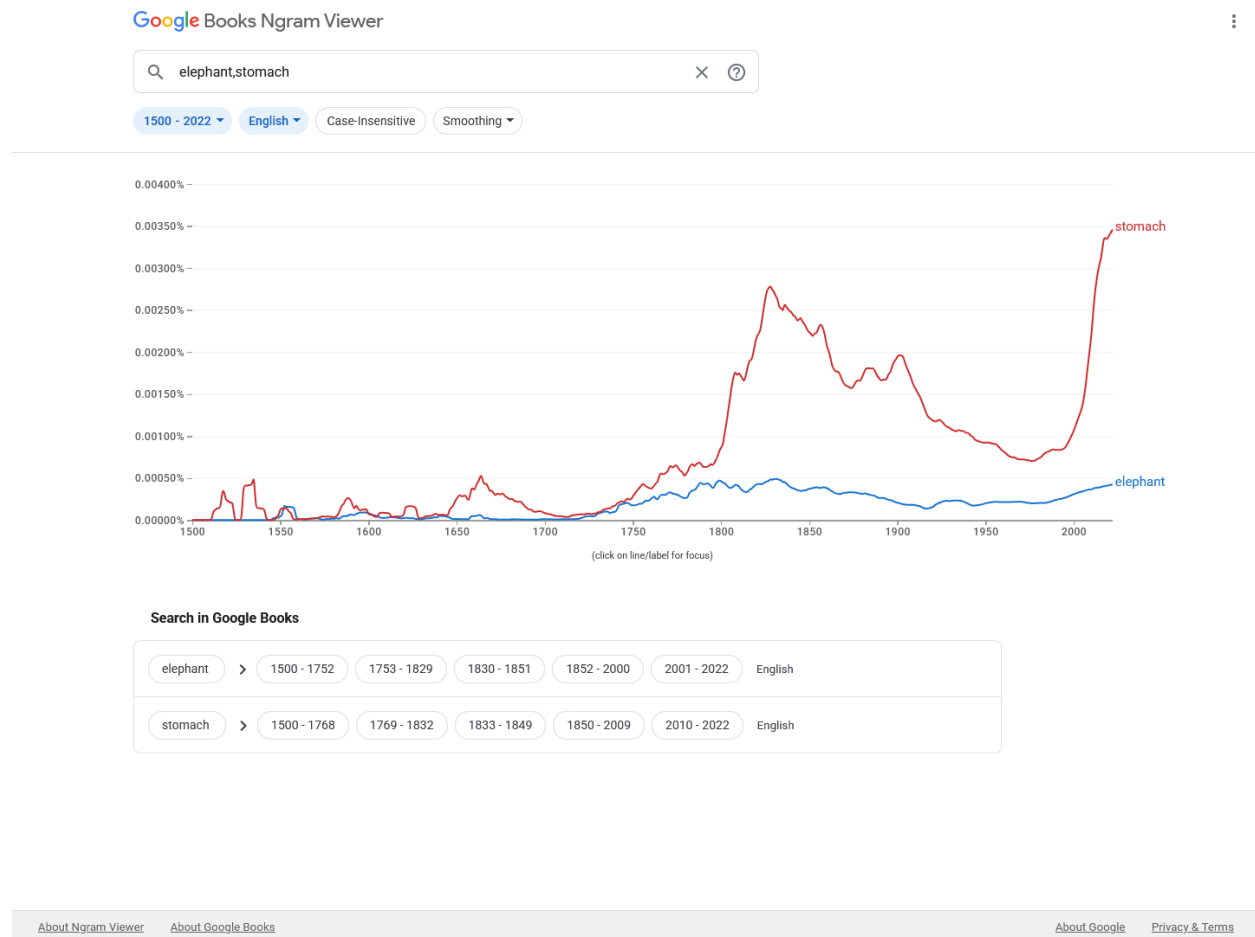
Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories, and Image Search. Elephant has the higher long-run average. Stomach nevertheless shows durable worldwide image-search interest across the full available range and a sharp recent peak that briefly exceeds elephant. This graph is included with that limitation visible rather than treated as a favorable result. Reproducible query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&gprop=images&q=stomach,elephant>



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-26 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, case-insensitive matching, and smoothing 3. Stomach substantially exceeds elephant in the latest displayed years and shows durable published-book use across the longest available range. Reproducible query: https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cstomach&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Stomach is independently useful and is not proposed to complete a set of organs.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

Nauseated Face can express nausea, and food emoji can identify meals or ingredients, but neither identifies the stomach itself. Hospital and pill can imply care or treatment without naming the affected organ. These substitutes cannot clearly express stomach-specific anatomy, digestion, hunger, fullness, discomfort, or figurative stomach meanings.

B. Overly specific

Stomach is a broad, familiar organ concept, not a disease, procedure, specialty, campaign, subtype, organization, or brand. It supports ordinary communication across food, digestion, sensation, emotion, education, nutrition, and health.

C. Open-ended

Encoding Stomach would not imply encoding liver, kidney, intestine, or every anatomical structure. Stomach stands on its own demonstrated usage, established figurative meanings, independent semantic gap, and compact J-shaped visual paradigm. Other concepts can be judged independently under the same criteria.

D. Transient

Stomach is a durable term and concept. The long-range Google Books record documents published use across centuries, while established expressions such as butterflies in the stomach and the verb sense of stomach are documented in current dictionaries. The proposal is not tied to a temporary event, product, or campaign.

E. Faulty comparison

The proposal does not depend on Anatomical Heart, Lungs, Brain, or another organ already being encoded. Its case rests on Stomach's own ordinary usage, established meanings, recognizable paradigm, and remaining gap in the emoji vocabulary.

Other Information

The singular common name Stomach is concise and searchable. Essential design cues are an asymmetric J-shaped hollow-organ body, a long visible inlet, a deep open inner concavity, and a distinct rounded outlet. Fine anatomical detail is optional and should yield to legibility at 18x18. Vendors should avoid a form that reads primarily as food, a bean, or a generic pink shape.